

Many regressions simultaneously

Jeff Leek

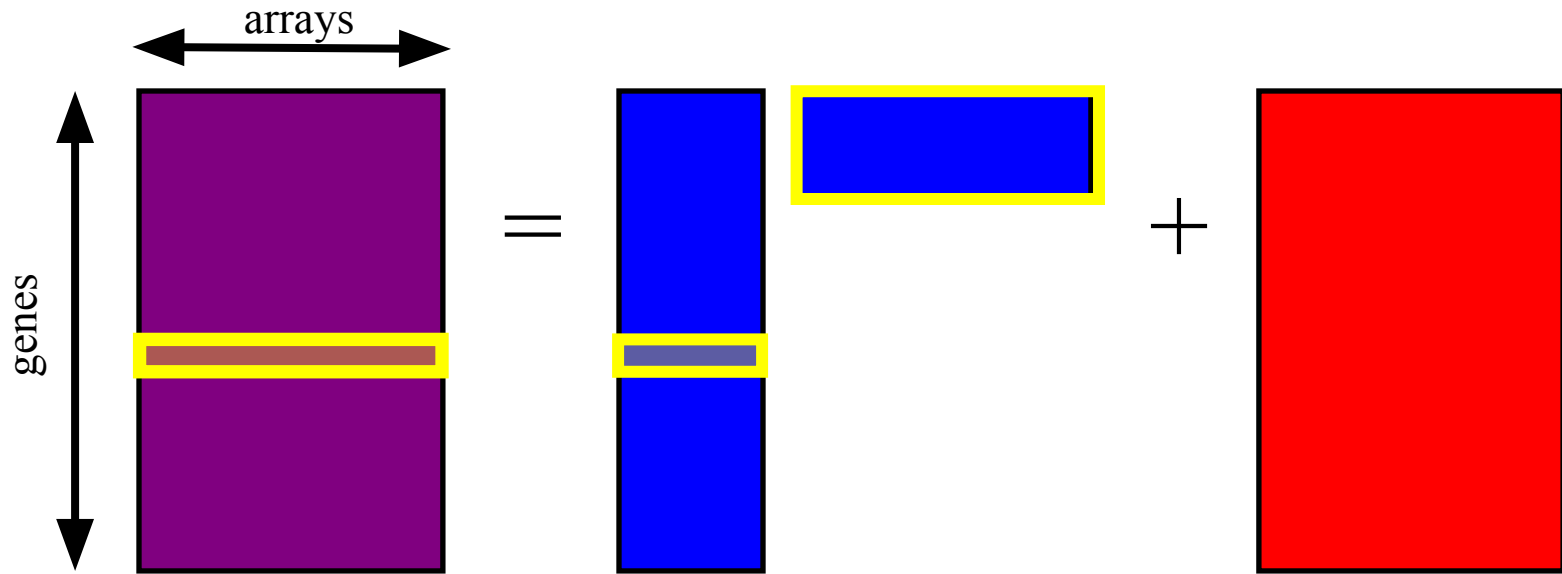
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Genomics measures many variables

	<i>VARYING CONDITIONS</i>				
	<i>sample 1</i>	<i>sample 2</i>	<i>sample 3</i>	<i>...</i>	<i>sample n</i>
<i>feature 1</i>	1.23	2.37	0.345	...	4.27
<i>feature 2</i>	3.98	1.09	0.237	...	0.283
<i>⋮</i>		<i>⋮</i>			<i>⋮</i>
<i>feature m</i>	0.896	2.81	3.92	...	1.46

A common goal is to find which of them relate to an outcome



$$\mathbf{X} = \mathbf{B} \mathbf{S}(\mathbf{Y}) + \mathbf{E}$$

A Genome-Wide Gene Expression Signature of Environmental Geography in Leukocytes of Moroccan Amazighs

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Abstract

The different environments that humans experience are likely to impact physiology and disease susceptibility. In order to estimate the magnitude of the impact of environment on transcript abundance, we examined gene expression in peripheral blood leukocyte samples from 46 desert nomadic, mountain agrarian and coastal urban Moroccan Amazigh individuals. Despite great expression heterogeneity in humans, as much as one third of the leukocyte transcriptome was found to be associated with differences among regions. Genome-wide polymorphism analysis indicates that genetic differentiation in the total sample is limited and is unlikely to explain the expression divergence. Methylation profiling of 1,505 CpG sites suggests limited contribution of methylation to the observed differences in gene expression. Genetic network analysis further implies that specific aspects of immune function are strongly affected by regional factors and may influence susceptibility to respiratory and inflammatory disease. Our results show a strong genome-wide gene expression signature of regional population differences that presumably include lifestyle, geography, and biotic factors, implying that these can play at least as great a role as genetic divergence in modulating gene expression variation in humans.

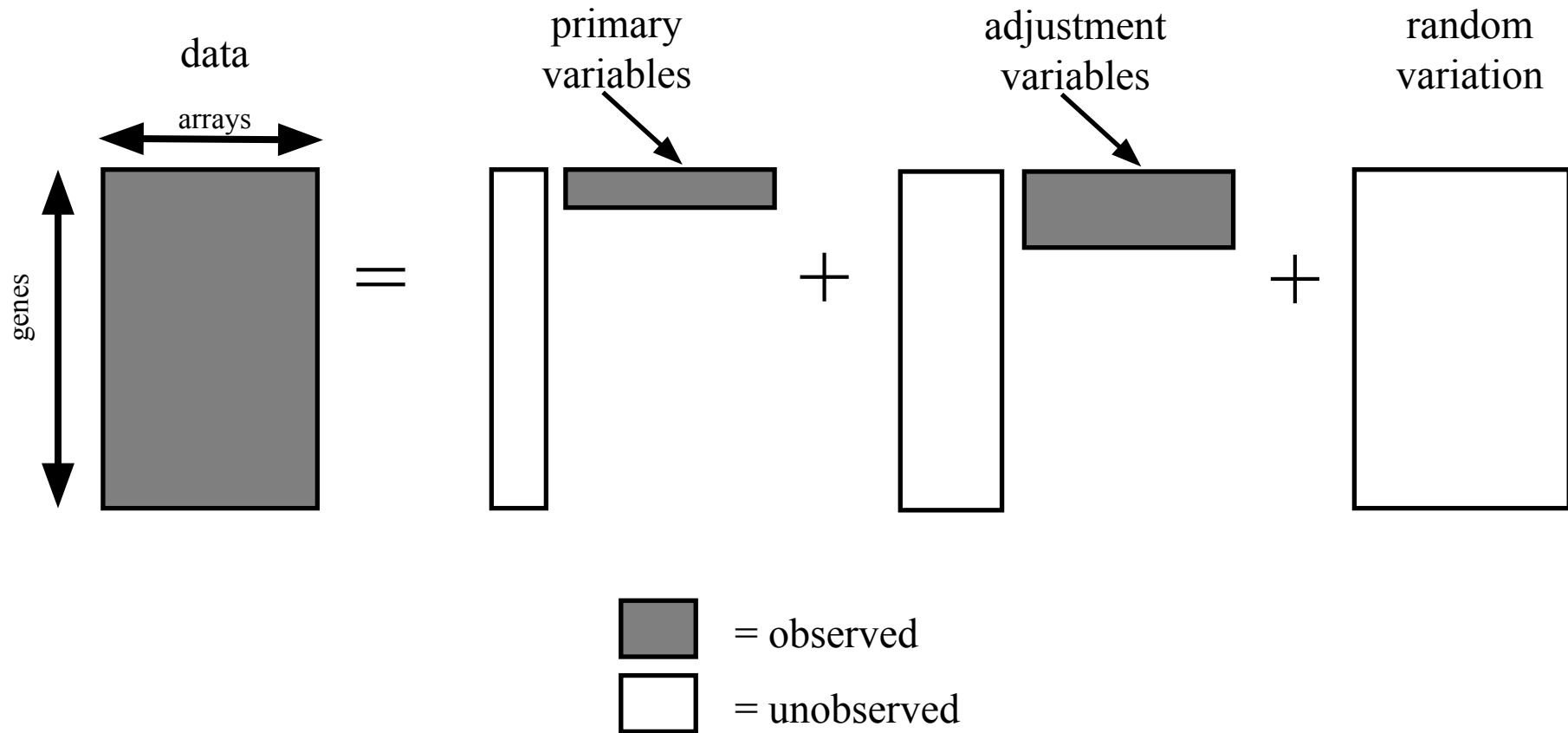
Primary (“Biological”) Variable

A	A	D	V	...	D	A	V
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Adjustment Variables

1	1	1	1	...	1	1	1
M	F	M	M	...	F	F	M
A	B	A	B	...	B	A	B

- Obvious:
 - Location (Agadir, Desert, Village)
 - Sex (female, male)
 - Batch (data generated in two batches)
- Subtle:
 - Intensity dependent effects
 - Dye effects
 - Probe composition effect
- Unknowns???



Result

- A set of hundreds, thousands, or millions of model fits
- For each model we have estimates, residuals, fitted values.
- There can now be structure in the estimates, structure in the noise, and all sorts of other issues (we'll address some shortly)

Notes and further reading

- Linear models is a whole class (no joke): <https://www.coursera.org/course/regmods>
- Linear models for microarray data: <http://www.statsci.org/smyth/pubs/limma-biocbook-reprint.pdf>